PROPERTY FINDER · PRODUCT BUILDER CHALLENGE

Trust Assistant: a short list you can believe

Prototype ↗ Repo ↗ Audit (Excel) ↗ Rules ↗ Probable bug ↗

Persona

Divyanshi, short-term renter
India → Dubai, first time

"Show me a studio I'd actually like, at the price I'll really pay."

Needs

- Studio with a real kitchen; monthly terms
- All-in ≤ AED 7,500/mo, approved by her company
- Safe building, metro or easy cabs
- Finalise from India, on her phone

Frustrations

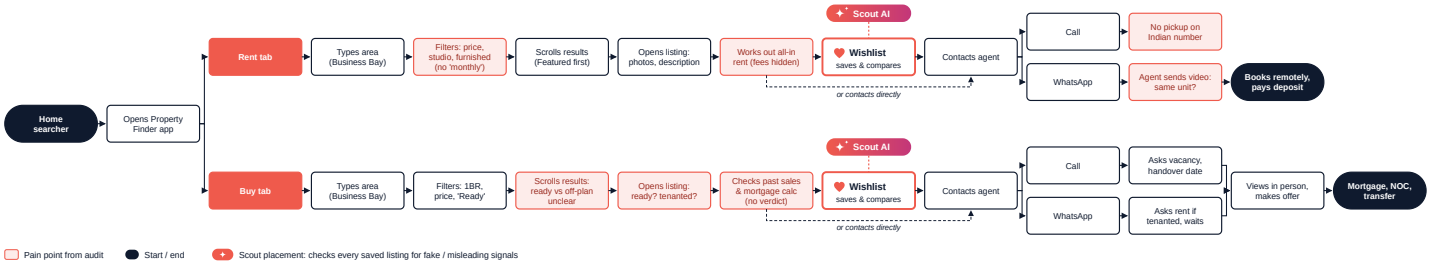
- Hidden fees broke an approved budget
- Bait photos; a different unit on WhatsApp
- Re-explains needs; agents ignore Indian numbers
- Only ~10 of 30 WhatsApps got a reply (my past search)
- Loses track across ~10 WhatsApp chats

Stakeholders

1. **Searcher** — Renter or buyer seeking a real home
2. **Agent / Agency** — Posts listings, earns from leads
3. **Property Owner** — Landlord or seller wanting a fair price
4. **Property Finder** — Balances agent revenue with searcher trust
5. **Holiday-Home Operators** — Short-stay units with hotel-style fees
6. **Developers** — Sell off-plan using renders and "from" prices

** I studied the renter's flow in depth; the buyer's flow only at a bird's-eye level, within this assignment's scope.*

User journey



The problem behind the problem

On the surface: some listings are fake. **Underneath:** from the page she can't tell which listings are real, available and within budget. So she messages everyone, waits, and gives up; honest listings get buried under bait; and PF never learns which listings misled her, because the truth comes out later on WhatsApp.
Audit, 32 live studios (Excel · repo): only 2/30 raise no warning sign · 0/30 let you work out the all-in price · 16/30 listed 90+ days ago · only 12/32 were worth an inquiry.

Rules · full set ↗

Every listing starts at **100**; each sign adds or takes points. **70+** Looks genuine · **40–69** Needs checking · **under 40** Likely misleading.

R1	No permit, or fake licence	−15 to −50	R2	"Studio" is really a hotel room	−20 / −30
R3	Two or more warning signs	by score	R4	Listed 90+ days: still free?	+5 to −35
R5	Price ±20% vs area median	−10 to −30	R6	Same unit, 2 agents, same price	+10 / −15
R7	Photos or size don't match	−10 / −20	R8	Hidden fees or conditional price	−10 to −30
R9	Building or location unclear	−10 / −20	R10	Buyer: handover, tenancy unclear	ask only

Also: agent (SuperAgent +5, rating under 3.5 −5), building reviews (+3 / −5). R3 needs no weight: two medium signs already drop a listing below 40. Weights reproduce the audit on 32/32 listings (in-sample).

Where it lives

In the **Wishlist**, on web and app: the ♥ is the trigger. Scout checks every saved home ("Scout checked your 32 saved homes: 8 look misleading"); each card shows **Looks genuine**, **Needs checking** or **Likely misleading** with a one-line reason. "Ask Scout to verify" drafts one message per agent; nothing is sent until she taps Send. Not on search results (I couldn't reach Scout): verdicts stay private, no public badge.

Why use it, and when not

Use it to find out: which listings are real, which agents are likely to reply, which listings are misleading, and which really fit the budget once the fees hidden in the description are added. **Don't:** when you already trust the agent, for viewings, negotiation or signing (it hands over to a human), or for legal or mortgage decisions.

Agents and PF revenue (a suggestion)

No data yet on the revenue impact, so this is the trade-off if PF ships it.
Pros: honest agents get serious leads and credit for stating fees; bait listings lose leads; verdicts stay private, so no public label hits paying agents; a trust edge over Bayut's TruCheck; PF learns which listings mislead. **Cons:** fewer raw leads at first, while PF earns per listing and lead; false flags can hurt honest agents (holiday homes look stale); agent pushback.

Metrics it moves

Portal metrics: searcher-to-lead rate, agent reply rate, lead-to-viewing/deal rate, returning searchers, agent spend.
What Scout should move, from the 32-listing audit: fewer messages wasted on poor listings (only 12/32 were worth one), a higher agent reply rate (~10/30 in my search), and a faster route to a trusted short list. The size of each move needs the 1% test.

One number that proves it: of the listings Scout keeps on the short list, the share where the agent confirms the unit is real, still available and at the price Scout showed (**confirmed-match rate**). **Test:** 1% of Business Bay and Marina rent searchers (web + app) get Scout for 4 weeks; the other 99% are the control. **Proves me wrong:** Scout's short list is confirmed no more than 5 points more often than the listings control users contact, or viewings per searcher stay flat.

What I could not build (priority order)

Feature	Why it's needed	Why I couldn't add it
1. Real agent replies	Real replies and reply rates (simulated / sample in the UI)	No WhatsApp or PF inbox integration; no reply data
2. Buyer-side prototype	The assistant must work for buyers too	Time; buyer research was bird's-eye only (8 listings, no interviews)
3. Pages for all listings	Only #11 and #16 open as full listing pages	Short on time
4. Live permit and licence check	R1: proves who the advertiser is	No DLD Trakheesi / DTCM data access
5. Live listing feed	Rules must run on every listing, not 32	No PF listings API; audit was by hand
6. Photo matching across listings	R7: catches recycled bait photo sets	Needs PF's image store plus engineering
7. DLD transaction prices	R5: fair price per building, esp. for buyers	No DLD feed; used listing medians instead
8. Outcome feedback loop	Contradicted listings reported to PF moderation	Needs PF backend and a moderation process
9. LLM reading of descriptions	Extracts fees and terms from free text	No API key; prototype uses fixed rules